

Group & Concurrent Therapy Guide

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Definitions & Requirements

GROUP THERAPY

- 2 to 6 patients treated at the same time
- Same therapist or assistant supervising all
- Same general activity or therapeutic program
- Therapist's attention is DIVIDED among patients
- Each patient must have individual goals
- Patient consent must be documented
- Billed individually for each patient

CONCURRENT THERAPY

- Exactly 2 patients treated at the same time
- Same therapist or assistant supervising both
- DIFFERENT activities for each patient
- Therapist's attention is DIVIDED between two
- Each patient performing their own program
- Patient consent must be documented
- Billed individually for each patient

Side-by-Side Comparison

	GROUP	CONCURRENT	INDIVIDUAL
Patients	2–6	Exactly 2	1
Activities	Same activity	Different activities	One patient focus
Therapist attention	Divided among all	Divided between 2	Fully focused on 1
Patient consent required	Yes	Yes	N/A
Billing	Per patient	Per patient	Per patient
Mode of Treatment %	Counts toward G/C%	Counts toward G/C%	Counts toward individual %
Best use case	Balance class, exercise group	2 patients with different needs	Complex or high-acuity patients

Group Therapy — Clinical Examples

GROUP — Balance & Fall Prevention Class

Patients: 4 patients: 2 post-hip fracture, 1 Parkinson's, 1 deconditioning

Activity: Standing balance tasks at parallel bars — weight shifting, step taps, cone reaches. Each patient at their own level of difficulty.

Note: Therapist grades difficulty per patient during session. Individual goals for each (PT). Document each patient's performance separately.

GROUP — Functional Strengthening Group

Patients: 3 patients: 2 post-surgical lower extremity, 1 cardiac deconditioning

Activity: Seated and standing strengthening exercises using bands and weights. Same exercise program adapted to each patient's resistance level.

Note: Document individual reps, resistance, and response for each patient. Note therapist modifications made per patient. (PT)

GROUP — ADL Skills Group

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Patients: 3 patients: 2 post-CVA with ADL deficits, 1 post-hip replacement

Activity: Upper body dressing practice using adaptive equipment. Each patient working on same task category but at different assist levels.

Note: OT group. Document each patient's individual assist level, cues required, and progress. Patient consent documented at start of group. (OT)

GROUP — Cognitive Skills Group

Patients: 4 patients: mixed cognitive-communication diagnoses

Activity: Structured group activity — card game, word puzzles, or current events discussion targeting attention, memory, and communication.

Note: ST or OT group. Document each patient's individual performance on targeted cognitive domain. Note quality of participation. (ST/OT)

GROUP — Dysphagia Management Group

Patients: 2–3 patients: similar dysphagia presentations, same diet texture level

Activity: Meal observation session with technique reinforcement — chin tuck, effortful swallow, pacing cues. Therapist monitors all during meal.

Note: ST. Each patient's swallowing safety monitored individually. Document s/s of aspiration, technique compliance, dietary intake. (ST)

Concurrent Therapy — Clinical Examples

CONCURRENT — PT & OT on Same Patient (Different disciplines)

Patients: 1 PT patient doing gait training, 1 OT patient doing ADL training — same time, same therapist

Activity: ONLY if one therapist is licensed in both PT and OT. PT patient ambulates with FWW while OT patient practices dressing at bedside.

Note: Each patient on a DIFFERENT task. Therapist attention divided. This is the most common concurrent scenario in SNF. Document each separately.

CONCURRENT — Two PT Patients — Different Programs

Patients: 2 PT patients with different goals in the gym at the same time

Activity: Patient A on treadmill for gait/endurance training. Patient B doing seated strengthening at parallel bars. Same PT supervising both.

Note: Must be DIFFERENT activities. Document start/stop time for both. Note that treatment was concurrent. Individual goals and notes required.

CONCURRENT — Two OT Patients — Different ADL Tasks

Patients: 2 OT patients with different ADL goals

Activity: Patient A: practicing upper body dressing with adaptive equipment. Patient B: working on meal setup and utensil use at table.

Note: Different tasks, same therapist, same time. Document individually. Therapist attention alternates between both patients. (OT)

CONCURRENT — Two ST Patients — Different Targets

Patients: 2 ST patients with different communication/swallowing goals

Activity: Patient A: working on word retrieval exercises (aphasia). Patient B: practicing effortful swallow technique (dysphagia).

Note: Completely different activities required. Same SLP supervising. Document each patient's session and performance separately. (ST)

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Documentation Requirements for Both Modes	
• Mode documented in the note	Must explicitly state "Group" or "Concurrent" — not just implied
• Number of patients in session	For group: state how many (e.g. "group of 4"). For concurrent: state "2 patients"
• Individual goals referenced	Each patient's note must reference their own specific goals, not the group goal
• Individual performance documented	Each patient gets their own note with their own response, assist level, and progress
• Patient consent on file	Both modes require documented patient consent — obtain at start of care or first G/C session
• Activities must match the mode	Group = same activity. Concurrent = different activities. Mismatch = billing error
• Therapist identified	Note which therapist or assistant supervised the session

When NOT to use Group or Concurrent: Do not use G/C therapy for high-acuity patients who require full therapist attention for safety. Do not use G/C as a scheduling convenience — it must be clinically appropriate. Do not bill concurrent with 3+ patients — that is group. Mode of treatment should never exceed what is clinically appropriate for the patient's needs.